



Death and Rebirth

The hero faces his biggest challenge yet, an essential part of a transformation. He experiences a near death experience, or actually dies and comes back to life.

Several events prevent Jake from accessing his Avatar but he regains access. He does this being offered a corrective surgery to fix his legs.

Arya decides to be Arya Stark, and rejects the offer to become one of the Faceless Men, despite being given the chance of being no one.

Thor faces multiple defeats before realising that the power was within him all along, after having a chat with Odin.

Frodo is left for dead by Sam after being poisoned. Sam does not know that the poison has merely made Frodo unconscious.

Agent Smith apparently kills Neo in the Matrix and real world. Trinity kisses Neo, and he comes back to life.

Luke goes into a self imposed exile, wanting to live his life as a hermit on Ahch-To. Rey seeks out the old Jedi Master.

Harry Potter is killed by the Dark Lord, but comes back to life as Voldemort only killed the seventh part of his soul.

Master of Two worlds

The hero finds balance in his life, and overcomes a fear of death, granting him the freedom to live. He grants his boon to the people, spreads his gifts, there may even be a party to celebrate. Everyone lives happily ever after.

Potter lives his life as an Auror, is integrated with the Wizarding World, gets married and has children who also go to Howarts.

Skywalker becomes one with the Force, just like Yoda, Anakin Skywalker and Obi Wan Kenobi.

Neo's remains are retrieved by the machines, and there are hints, including from the Oracle, that Neo in fact survives the ending.

Frodo lives in peace in The Shire, but is in pain because of the knife wound. He sails west with Gandalf, Elrond and Galadriel.

Thor finds a balance in his new role as not the captain alongside the Asgardians of the Galaxy.

Arya leaves behind Westeros, and heads west, in search of new lands and adventures.

Jake lives on Pandora, and becomes a part of the Na'vi.

The Return Threshold

The point in the story during which the hero gets back to the regular world, from the fantasy realm. At times, this can just be a boring return journey.

Jake chooses to stay on Pandora. He undergoes a ceremony where his soul is permanently transferred to his Avatar body.

Arya escapes from Dany's burning of King's Landing on a white horse.

Thor returns to Wakanda with one of the few weapons that can defeat Thanos, and almost manages to do so.

Frodo makes the long trek back to The Shire, and as a final adventure, has to clear out The Shire from the forces of Saruman.

Neo chooses to delete himself just as Agent Smith is assimilating him, killing both of them.

Skywalker hears a voice from Obi Wan Kenobi, urging him to let go. Skywalker notes his journey is ends just as it began.

Voldemort is no longer in control, and return to status quo is when the Ministry of Magic comes back to power.

The Reward

The hero returns with the reward to the regular world, and this reward typically is what is necessary to save the world, or restore it.

Harry does hang on to the invisibility cloak though, passing it on to his children.

The efforts of Skywalker allows the Resistance to escape, saving the lives of many people in the process.

Neo makes a deal with the machines, to take out the agent Smith in exchange for a cease fire against humans, and ends the war.

The Dark Lord and his servants are defeated, and Aragorn is crowned king.

Thor nearly dies after exposing himself to the raw energies of a star, but manages to help Etri the dwarf forge Stormbreaker.

Arya stabs the Night King with the catspaw dagger, killing him and destroying the forces of the night.

Jake successfully leads the Pandorans against the Sky People, and sends the military expedition back to Earth.

The Magic Flight

This is not a necessary step, but in some adventures, the hero has to escape with a closely guarded artefact, weapon or secret.

Jake becomes a rider a great Toruk, and is only the sixth Toruk Makto, or Rider of the Last Shadow in Pandoran history.

Melisandre encourages Arya to go and kill the Night King.

Thor escapes from The Ragnarok with all his people on board a ship.

Frodo and Sam are rescued from the erupting Mount Doom by Gandalf, who arrives on the Eagles.

Neo is on board a ship, Logos, as he heads to the Machine city. Although blindfolded, Neo manages to destroy swarms of bots.

Skywalker meditates, and regains his force abilities. He projects a vision that confronts his nephew, Kylo Ren.

Harry returns to the living, but continues to play dead, so that he can defeat Voldemort in a final confrontation.

Atonement

The hero encounters a being of incredible power, and gains new knowledge and perception. This is where the hero uncovers the source of his power.

Harry Potter receives the elder wand, but throws to break it and throw it away, destroying its power forever.

R2D2 shows Luke the message from Leia once again, convincing him to train Rey in the ways of the force.

Neo can see The Matrix as raw code. He defeats the agents by stopping their bullets mid-air. Neo also rescues kids from the clutches of The Matrix.

Frodo refuses to cast The Ring into the Cracks of Doom, but Gollum bites of his finger with the ring still on it, and falls into the lava pits.

Thor helps save his people, but ends up destroying Asgard in the process.

Arya heads back to Westeros, and avenges the Red Wedding by killing off all the Freys using poison.

Jake rallies the natives and motivates them to fight against the humans, or the Sky People.